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Remote subscription profile download

Abstract

There is provided mechanisms for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity. A method is performed by a network node of an SNPN. The method comprises receiving a request from the subscriber entity for network registration with EAP based authentication to the SNPN. The method comprises granting network connectivity for the subscriber entity to the SNPN by completing the network registration upon successful EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity. The network connectivity enables subscription profile download to the subscriber entity.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is a 35 U.S.C. § 371 national stage application of PCT International Application No. PCT/EP2020/068101 filed on Jun. 26, 2020, the disclosure and content of which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) Embodiments presented herein relate to a method, a network node of a stand-alone non-public network (SNPN), a computer program, and a computer program product for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity. Further embodiments presented herein relate to a method, a subscriber entity, a computer program, and a computer program product for subscription profile download. Further embodiments presented herein relate to a method, a subscription management server, a computer program, and a computer program product for assisting the network node to enable subscription profile download to the subscriber entity.

BACKGROUND

(3) Remote SIM provisioning (RSP; where SIM is short for subscriber identity module) for consumer devices is described in “SGP.22-RSP Technical Specification”, Version 2.2.1, 18 Dec. 2018, published by the GSM Association. According to this document, firstly, the subscriber makes a contract with a mobile network operator (MNO). Secondly, the MNO orders a profile for the subscriber entity from a server (enhanced Subscription Manager Data Preparation (SM-DP+) server), and the SM-DP+ creates the profile and returns to the MNO a pointer to the profile. Thirdly, the MNO delivers the pointer for download initialization of the profile to the subscriber. Fourthly, the profile is downloaded from the SM-DP+ to the embedded universal integrated circuit card (eUICC) in the communication device to be provisioned. Section 3.1 of the aforementioned document describes the profile download initiation process. It indicates how the user orders a subscription from the MNO. Request/response methods are used for the MNO to request the SM-DP+ to create a SIM profile. The profile is then stored securely in the SM-DP+. After profile creation, the subscriber entity can download the created profile by contacting the SM-DP+ using the communication device.

(4) The above referred technical specification documents suggest that the device to be provisioned (denoted companion device) can be managed through a primary device (e.g., a User Equipment), which can e.g. provide global connectivity (through e.g. WiFi tethering) to the device to be provisioned and act as the input device for entering e.g. the activation code of the device to be provisioned. The technical specification SGP.22 also defines a GetEID function that can be used for retrieving the EID of the device to be provisioned.

(5) However, it could be that, for form factor reasons or cost reasons, the device to be provisioned is not provided with the necessary communication interfaces, such as a communication interface for Bluetooth or WiFi communication, for communicating with the primary device. There is therefore a need for improved remote provisioning of subscription profiles to subscriber entities, such as eUICCs.

SUMMARY

(6) An object of embodiments herein is to enable efficient remote provisioning of a subscription profile to a subscriber entity.

(7) According to a first aspect there is presented a method for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity. The method is performed by a network node of an SNPN. The method comprises receiving a request from the subscriber entity for network registration with EAP based authentication to the SNPN. The method comprises granting network connectivity for the subscriber entity to the SNPN by completing the network registration upon successful EAP based

authentication of the subscriber entity and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity. The network connectivity enables subscription profile download to the subscriber entity.

(8) According to a second aspect there is presented a network node of an SNPN for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity. The network node comprises processing circuitry. The processing circuitry is configured to cause the network node to receive a request from the subscriber entity for network registration with EAP based authentication to the SNPN. The processing circuitry is configured to cause the network node to grant network connectivity for the subscriber entity to the SNPN by completing the network registration upon successful EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity. The network connectivity enables subscription profile download to the subscriber entity.

(9) According to a third aspect there is presented a computer program for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity. The computer program comprises computer program code which, when run on processing circuitry of a network node of a SNP, causes the network node to perform a method according to the first aspect.

(10) According to a fourth aspect there is presented a method for subscription profile download. The method is performed by a subscriber entity. The method comprises providing a request for network registration with EAP based authentication to an SNPN. The method comprises gaining network connectivity to the SNPN upon successful EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity. The method comprises obtaining event information of the subscription profile. The method comprises downloading the subscription profile to the subscriber entity whilst utilizing the network connectivity to the SNPN.

(11) According to a fifth aspect there is presented a subscriber entity for subscription profile download. The subscriber entity comprises processing circuitry. The processing circuitry is configured to cause the subscriber entity to provide a request for network registration with EAP based authentication to an SNPN. The processing circuitry is configured to cause the subscriber entity to gain network connectivity to the SNPN upon successful EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity. The processing circuitry is configured to cause the subscriber entity to obtain event information of the subscription profile. The processing circuitry is configured to cause the subscriber entity to download the subscription profile to the subscriber entity whilst utilizing the network connectivity to the SNPN.

(12) According to a sixth aspect there is presented a computer program for subscription profile download. The computer program comprises computer program code which, when run on processing circuitry of a subscriber entity, causes the subscriber entity to perform a method according to the fourth aspect.

(13) According to a seventh aspect there is presented a method for assisting a network node of an SNPN to enable subscription profile download to a subscriber entity. The method is performed by a subscription management server. The method comprises obtaining, from the network node, a trigger for the subscription management server to verify that a pending subscription profile is available for download to the subscriber entity. The method comprises, then, providing an indication to the network node that the pending subscription profile is available for download to the subscriber entity. The indication assists the network node to enable subscription profile download to the subscriber entity.

(14) According to an eighth aspect there is presented a subscription management server for assisting a network node of an SNPN to enable subscription profile download to a subscriber entity. The subscription management server comprises processing circuitry. The processing circuitry is configured to cause the subscription management server to obtain, from the network node, a trigger

for the subscription management server to verify that a pending subscription profile is available for download to the subscriber entity. The processing circuitry is configured to cause the subscription management server to, then, provide an indication to the network node that the pending subscription profile is available for download to the subscriber entity. The indication assists the network node to enable subscription profile download to the subscriber entity.

(15) According to a tenth aspect there is presented a computer program for assisting a network node of an SNPN to enable subscription profile download to a subscriber entity, the computer program comprising computer program code which, when run on processing circuitry of a subscription management server, causes the subscription management server to perform a method according to the seventh aspect.

(16) According to an eleventh aspect there is presented a computer program product comprising a computer program according to at least one of the third aspect, the sixth aspect, and the tenth aspect and a computer readable storage medium on which the computer program is stored. The computer readable storage medium can be a non-transitory computer readable storage medium.

(17) Advantageously these aspects enable efficient remote provisioning of a subscription profile to the subscriber entity.

(18) Advantageously, according to these aspects, the subscriber entity is enabled to gain initial network connectivity even without a valid subscription in order to download a proper subscription profile.

(19) Advantageously, according to these aspects, already provisioned subscriber entities are prevented from gaining network connectivity through the SNPN, thus lessening the burden on the SNPN.

(20) Other objectives, features and advantages of the enclosed embodiments will be apparent from the following detailed disclosure, from the attached dependent claims as well as from the drawings.

(21) Generally, all terms used in the claims are to be interpreted according to their ordinary meaning in the technical field, unless explicitly defined otherwise herein. All references to “a/an/the element, apparatus, component, means, module, step, etc.” are to be interpreted openly as referring to at least one instance of the element, apparatus, component, means, module, step, etc., unless explicitly stated otherwise.

(22) The steps of any method disclosed herein do not have to be performed in the exact order disclosed, unless explicitly stated.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The inventive concept is now described, by way of example, with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram illustrating a communication network according to embodiments;
- (3) FIGS. 2, 3, and 4 are flowcharts of methods according to embodiments;
- (4) FIGS. 5, 6, and 7 are signalling diagrams according to embodiments;
- (5) FIG. 8 is a schematic diagram showing functional units of a network node according to an embodiment;
- (6) FIG. 9 is a schematic diagram showing functional modules of a network node according to an embodiment;
- (7) FIG. 10 is a schematic diagram showing functional units of a subscriber entity according to an embodiment;
- (8) FIG. 11 is a schematic diagram showing functional modules of a subscriber entity according to an embodiment;
- (9) FIG. 12 is a schematic diagram showing functional units of a subscription management server

according to an embodiment;

(10) FIG. 13 is a schematic diagram showing functional modules of a subscription management server according to an embodiment; and

(11) FIG. 14 shows one example of a computer program product comprising computer readable means according to an embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(12) The inventive concept will now be described more fully hereinafter with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which certain embodiments of the inventive concept are shown. This inventive concept may, however, be embodied in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein; rather, these embodiments are provided by way of example so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey the scope of the inventive concept to those skilled in the art. Like numbers refer to like elements throughout the description. Any step or feature illustrated by dashed lines should be regarded as optional.

(13) The embodiments disclosed herein relate to mechanisms for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity. In order to obtain such mechanisms there is provided a network node of an SNPN, a method performed by the network node, a computer program product comprising code, for example in the form of a computer program, that when run on processing circuitry of the network node, causes the network node to perform the method. In order to obtain such mechanisms there is further provided a subscriber entity, a method performed by the subscriber entity, and a computer program product comprising code, for example in the form of a computer program, that when run on processing circuitry of the subscriber entity, causes the subscriber entity to perform the method. In order to obtain such mechanisms there is further provided a subscription management server, a method performed by the subscription management server, and a computer program product comprising code, for example in the form of a computer program, that when run on processing circuitry of the subscription management server, causes the subscription management server to perform the method.

(14) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram illustrating a communication network 10 where embodiments presented herein can be applied. The communications network 10 comprises a number of sub-networks; a public land mobile network (PLMN) 20, an SNPN 30, and a service data network 40, such as the Internet. The PLMN 20 and the SNPN 30 are operatively connected to the service data network 40. Network access to the PLMN 20 and the SNPN 30 for a subscriber entity 200 is provided by a (radio) access network ((R)AN) node 50, representing a (radio) access network. The SNPN 30 comprises entities, as represented by network node 100. The service data network 40 comprises, or is operatively connected to, a subscription provisioning server 60, such as a SM-DP+, and a subscription management server 300, such as a SM-DS. The subscriber entity might be any of: an embedded Subscriber Identity Module (eSIM), an embedded Universal Integrated Circuit Card (eUICC) entity, an integrated Universal Integrated Circuit Card (iUICC) entity, a European Telecommunications Standards Institute Smart Secure Platform, (ETSI SSP), or the like. The subscriber entity might be provided in a portable wireless device, mobile station, mobile phone, handset, wireless local loop phone, user equipment (UE), smartphone, laptop computer, tablet computer, consumer IoT device, machine type IoT device, network equipped sensor, vehicle equipped sensor, or the like.

(15) Further details of the SNPN will now be disclosed. In addition to the public land mobile networks (PLMN), non-public networks (NPNs) have been defined for the fifth generation (5G) telecommunications systems. This implies that at least parts of the 5G telecommunications systems are operated by a private network operator which only allows certain pre-registered clients to attach to it. How the network functionality is split between the private network operator and a public network operator can vary; all functionality can be provided by the private network operator, or parts, e.g. (R) AN and/or control plane functionalities can be provided by the public network operator as a service for the private network operator. The NPN might in some aspects be regarded

as a stand-alone NPN (SNPN), even if the (R) AN is provided by the public network operator. For SNPNs, any EAP based authentication procedure can be used, and e.g. certificates could be used instead of traditional SIM credentials (international mobile subscriber identity (IMSI) and subscriber key). When performing EAP based authentication in a 5G core network, the Security Anchor Function (SEAF) acts as the EAP authenticator and the Authentication Server Function (AUSF) acts as the EAP (authentication) server, with the Unified Data Manager (UDM) being the credential database.

(16) When an NPN is accessed via a public network operator the (radio) access network node of the public network might advertise the network identifier (NID) of the private network(s) reachable through it. Globally unique NIDs can be assigned such that each NID is either globally unique, independent of the PLMN ID used, or so that the combination of each NID and PLMN ID is globally unique. Different combinations of PLMN ID and NID might point towards the same 5G core network. When accessing an SNPN using the (R) AN of a PLMN, the Subscription Permanent Identifier (SUPI) of the communication device can include the NID as the realm part of the Network Access Identifier (NAI). In this way the request can be forwarded by the (R) AN to the SNPN instead of the PLMN.

(17) Reference is continued to FIG. 1 with reference to steps A, B, C, D for disclosure of a method for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity **200** based on at least some of the embodiments disclosed herein.

(18) The subscriber entity **200** might be pre-programmed (by the manufacturer) with at least one NID used for subscriber entity **200** initial network connectivity. The SNPNs **30** that will provide this service of providing subscriber entity **200** initial network connectivity should serve this at least one NID, i.e. the PLMNs **20** providing a (R) AN to the SNPNs **30** need to advertise this at least one NID on behalf of the SNPNs **30**. Each NID could be either globally unique or become globally unique only when combined with a PLMN ID. In both cases the NID would still be served by many PLMNs **20**. Either approach could be used according to the herein disclosed embodiments.

(19) Step A: Initial Network Connectivity to (Global) Provisioning SNPN **30**

(20) When the subscriber entity **200** is switched on, and it does not have any existing subscription profile that can provide it with network connectivity (or if no subscription profile is active), the subscriber entity **200** will scan for the NID that has been pre-programmed to the subscriber entity **200** as a NID for subscription profile provisioning. Any PLMN **20** advertising the NID via its (R) AN or otherwise broadcasting information indicating that provisioning can be done through it, is a valid choice for the subscriber entity **200**.

(21) The subscriber entity **200** also (at some point before sending the first message) generates a SUPI using the (global) provisioning NID in the realm part of the SUPI. For EAP-TLS based authentication the client certificate, which can be seen as the identity of the subscriber entity **200**, is sent later in the exchange. Therefore, the identity part of the SUPI could be any of: a public key, hash of public key, random data, static data, empty—as the actual identity is provided later. As the subscriber entity **200** does not know the public key of the SNPN **30** it cannot encrypt the identity part of the SUPI to generate a Subscription Concealed Identifier (SUCI). However, the identity part is not relevant to the SNPN **30**, which instead uses the certificate (or public key thereof) sent later as the actual identity of the subscriber entity **200**. In some aspects, only the realm part of the SUPI is sent as SUCI, without the username/identity part. In this way, if EAP-TLS is used, privacy is preserved, especially if TLS provides privacy.

(22) The subscriber entity **200** initiates the network registration procedure with a (R) AN advertising the (global) provisioning NID. The registration message is by the (R) AN forwarded to the SNPN **30** based on the NID used as realm part of SUPI/SUCI of the subscriber entity **200**.

(23) The SNPN **30** implements at least the functions necessary for authentication, as well as User Plane Function (UPF) for providing global network connectivity for performing the actual subscription profile provisioning, and the SNPN **30** might perform Extensible Authentication

Protocol Transport Layer Security (EAP-TLS) based authentication with the subscriber entity **200**. The subscriber entity **200** is authenticated to the SNPN **30** using e.g. its EID and associated certificate, which has been issued by the Certificate Issuer (CI). The SNPN **30** is authenticated to the subscriber entity **200** using the certificate that has been issued by the same CI. In this respect, the CI might also issue a certificate to the SNPN(s) **30** that are going to provide network connectivity for provisioning purposes. Such a certificate can be used for authenticating the SNPN(s) **30** towards the subscriber entity **200** as a trusted network based on the SNPN(s) **30** having a certificate issued by the trusted CI.

(24) As an alternative the authentication of the subscriber entity **200** is performed with an external, authentication, authorization, and accounting (AAA) server, such as the subscription management server **300**. This would require that the subscription management server **300** supports EAP based authentication and that the SNPN **30** trusts the subscription management server **300** to act as AAA server for clients of the SNPN **30**.

(25) Step B: Authorizing Device for Access to the (Global) Provisioning SNPN **30**

(26) As part of authentication of the subscriber entity **200**, and before granting network access to the subscriber entity **200**, i.e. before sending an EAP SUCCESS MESSAGE to the subscriber entity **200**, the SNPN **30** connects to the subscription management server **300** to check whether there are any pending subscription profile download events for the subscriber entity **200** that has just authenticated. This filters out subscriber entities **200** that do not have subscription profile downloads pending but still try to access the SNPN **30**. This thus saves resources in the SNPN **30** and partially protects against misuse of the SNPN **30**. An interface between the SNPN **30** and the subscription management server **300** could be based on any of the following alternatives.

(27) According to a first alternative, the SNPN **30** has a CI signed certificate with metadata indicating it is an SNPN **30** for subscriber entity **200** provisioning, i.e. it would have different access rights towards the subscription management server **300**. Subscriber entities **200** would only be able to fetch their own subscription profile download events from the subscription management server **300**, whilst the SNPN **30** would be allowed to fetch subscription profile download events of any subscriber entities **200**.

(28) According to a second alternative, instead of providing the complete details of the subscription profile download event to the SNPN **30**, the subscription management server **300** only provides a true/false answer regarding whether there is any subscription profile download event for the queried subscriber entity **200**, i.e. does not provide the complete details of the subscription profile download event, to the SNPN **30**.

(29) Once the subscription management server **300** has informed the SNPN **30** that there is indeed a subscription profile download event pending for the subscriber entity **200** that has just authenticated to the SNPN **30**, the SNPN **30** can grant network access to the subscriber entity **200** for user plane traffic. If no subscription profile download event is pending, the SNPN **30** responds with an error message to the subscriber entity **200**, indicating that the registration was rejected, possibly with a reason, such as service not allowed. This implies that only subscriber entities **200** that actually have a subscription profile waiting to be downloaded would get network access to the SNPN **30**.

(30) Step C: Locating Provisioning Server

(31) The subscriber entity **200** obtains information related to the subscription profile download event. Two alternatives of how the subscriber entity **200** could obtain the information related to the subscription profile download event will be presented next.

(32) According to a first alternative, the SNPN **30** verifies that there is a subscription profile download event for the subscriber entity **200** in the subscription management server **300**, and the SNPN **30** could optionally learn the content of the subscription profile download event. If the SNPN **30** learns the content of the subscription profile download event, the SNPN **30** could communicate this information to the subscriber entity **200**, e.g. in the form of an AC (i.e. the same

format the provisioning information is provided to the user when he registers for a subscription from a mobile network operator). The subscriber entity **200** does thereby not need to connect to the subscription management server **300** to fetch the subscription profile download event.

(33) According to a second alternative, if the content of the subscription profile download event has not been communicated to the subscriber entity **200** by the SNPN **30**, after completing network registration with the SNPN **30**, the subscriber entity **200** can connect to the subscription management server **300** through the UPF of the SNPN **30**. The SNPN **30**/UPF can implement filtering/limitations for which network services the subscriber entity **200** is allowed access, e.g. only allowing connections to services with CI issued certificates, thereby limiting the network connectivity to only subscription provisioning servers **60** and subscription management server **300s**.

(34) Step D: Subscription Profile Provisioning of Subscriber Entity **200**

(35) The subscriber entity **200** connects to the subscription provisioning server **60** indicated by the subscription profile download event obtained from the subscription management server **300** to download the subscription profile. The SNPN **30** allows the connection to the subscription provisioning server **60** based on any of the following alternatives:

(36) According to a first alternative, there is a static pre-configuration of trusted subscription provisioning servers **60**.

(37) According to a second alternative, there is a dynamic configuration by the SNPN **30** of subscription provisioning servers **60** based on information learned from the subscription profile download event fetched from the subscription management server **300**.

(38) In some examples, the SNPN **30** configures subscriber entity **200** specific rules to the UPF e.g. based on the information obtained from the subscription management server **300**; if the SNPN **30** has fetched the content of the subscription profile download event in the subscription management server **300**, the subscriber entity **200** specific rules could specify to only allow network connectivity of the subscriber entities **200** to the subscription provisioning server **60** indicated in the subscription profile download event.

(39) According to a fourth alternative, the SNPN **30** inspects the traffic flow between the subscriber entity **200** and the subscription provisioning server **60** and verifies that the subscription provisioning server **60** has a CI issued certificate, e.g. by connecting to the subscription provisioning server **60** itself and verifying it (and after that potentially adding the subscription provisioning server **60** to a configuration list of trusted subscription provisioning servers **60**).

(40) When the subscriber entity **200** has successfully downloaded and installed a new subscription profile, according to subscriber entity **200** provisioning specification, the subscriber entity **200** can start using its downloaded subscription, instead of the SNPN **30** provisioning network, for network connectivity.

(41) Reference is now made to FIG. 2 illustrating a method for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity **200** as performed by the network node **100** of the SNPN **30** according to an embodiment.

(42) S102: The network node **100** receives a request from the subscriber entity **200** for network registration with EAP based authentication to the SNPN **30**. As part of network registration, EAP based authentication is performed between the subscriber entity **200** and the network node **100**.

(43) S110: The network node **100** grants network connectivity for the subscriber entity **200** to the SNPN **30** by completing the network registration upon successful EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity **200** and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity **200**. The network connectivity enables subscription profile download to the subscriber entity **200**.

(44) Embodiments relating to further details of enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity **200** as performed by the network node **100** will now be disclosed.

(45) There could be different types of EAP based authentication procedures. In some embodiments,

the EAP based authentication is based on EAP-TLS authentication of the subscriber entity **200**. In some embodiments, the EAP based authentication comprises verifying a CI issued certificate of the subscriber entity **200** or an identifier of the subscriber entity **200**. In some examples, the network node **100** is authenticated to the subscriber entity **200** using the certificate that has been issued by the same CI as issued the certificate for the subscriber entity **200**. In some embodiments, the EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity **200** is performed by the network node **100**. In some embodiments, the EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity **200** is performed by the subscription management server **300**. Hence, in some embodiments the network node **100** is configured to perform (optional) step **S104**:

(46) **S104**: The network node **100** obtains an indication from a subscription management server **300** of successful EAP based authentication, as performed by the subscription management server **300**, of the subscriber entity **200**.

(47) The indication might be an EAP SUCCESS message obtained from the subscription management server **300** and addressed to the subscriber entity **200** (i.e., the EAP SUCCESS message is intended to finally reach the subscriber entity **200**).

(48) In some aspects, the network node **100** obtains an indication that there is a pending subscription profile download event for the subscriber entity **200**. In particular, in some embodiments, the verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity **200** is obtained as an indication from a subscription management server **300**. Examples of such an indication will be disclosed next.

(49) In some aspects, the indication is indirect in the form of an EAP SUCCESS message sent from the subscription management server **300** to the subscriber entity **200**. That is, in some embodiments, the indication is an EAP SUCCESS message obtained from the subscription management server **300** and addressed to the subscriber entity **200**.

(50) In some aspects, the indication is an explicit response. In particular, in some embodiments, the indication is obtained from the subscription management server **300** in a response message to a querying. The network node **100** might thus explicitly query the subscription management server **300** if there is pending subscription profile download event for the subscriber entity **200**. Therefore, in some embodiments, the network node **100** is configured to perform (optional) step **S106**:

(51) **S106**: The network node **100** queries the subscription management server **300** for existence of the pending subscription profile download event for the subscriber entity **200** at the subscription management server **300**.

(52) In some aspects the network node **100** receives information of the subscription profile from the subscription management server **300**. That is, in some embodiments, the network node **100** is configured to perform (optional) step **S108**:

(53) **S108**: The network node **100** obtains subscription profile download event information of the pending subscription profile from a subscription management server **300**.

(54) The network node **100** might then provide this information to the subscriber entity **200**.

Particularly, in some embodiments, as part of completing the network registration, the network node **100** provides, to the subscriber entity **200**, the subscription profile download event information of the pending subscription profile.

(55) Reference is now made to FIG. **3** illustrating a method for subscription profile download as performed by the subscriber entity **200** according to an embodiment.

(56) **S204**: The subscriber entity **200** provides a request for network registration with EAP based authentication to an SNPN **30**.

(57) As disclosed above, the subscriber entity **200** is granted network access only upon successful authentication and when there is a pending subscription profile available for download.

(58) **S206**: The subscriber entity **200** gains network connectivity to the SNPN **30** upon successful EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity **200** and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity **200**.

(59) **S208**: The subscriber entity **200** obtains subscription profile download event information of the subscription profile.

(60) **S210**: The subscriber entity **200** downloads the subscription profile to the subscriber entity **200** whilst utilizing the network connectivity to the SNPN **30**.

(61) Embodiments relating to further details of subscription profile download as performed by the subscriber entity **200** will now be disclosed.

(62) In some aspects the subscriber entity **200** scans for broadcast information, e.g. NIDs, in order to detect the SNPN **30**. That is, in some embodiments, the subscriber entity **200** is configured with broadcast information of the SNPN **30** to use for initial network connectivity, and configured to perform (optional) step:

(63) **S202**: The subscriber entity **200** scans received wireless signals for the broadcast information before providing the request for EAP based network registration to the SNPN **30**.

(64) There could be different types of broadcast information. In some examples, the broadcast information is a NID of the SNPN **30**.

(65) As disclosed above, as part of the network registration, the subscriber entity **200** might performs EAP based authentication with either the network node **100** or the subscription management server **300**. As disclosed above, in some examples, the network node **100** is authenticated to the subscriber entity **200** using the certificate that has been issued by the same CI as issued the certificate for the subscriber entity **200**.

(66) As disclosed above, in some examples the subscription profile download event information of the pending subscription profile is provided by the network node **100**, and thus obtained by the subscriber entity **300** from the SNPN **30**, as part of completing the network registration.

(67) Reference is now made to FIG. **4** illustrating a method for assisting a network node **100** of an SNPN **30** to enable subscription profile download to a subscriber entity **200** as performed by the subscription management server **300** according to an embodiment.

(68) **S302**: The subscription management server **300** obtains, from the network node **100**, a trigger for the subscription management server **300** to verify that a pending subscription profile is available for download to the subscriber entity **200**.

(69) In this respect, the trigger might be a request from the network node **100** for the subscription management server **300** to check there is a subscription profile download event for subscription profile download pending for the subscriber entity **200**.

(70) **S306**: The subscription management server **300**, then, provides an indication to the network node **100** that the pending subscription profile is available for download to the subscriber entity **200**. The indication assists the network node **100** to enable subscription profile download to the subscriber entity **200**.

(71) Embodiments relating to further details of assisting a network node **100** of an SNPN **30** to enable subscription profile download to a subscriber entity **200** as performed by the subscription management server **300** will now be disclosed.

(72) In some aspects the subscription management server **300** verifies the network node **100** before sending any information to the network node **100**. That is, in some embodiments, the subscription management server **300** is configured to perform (optional) step **S304**:

(73) **S304**: The subscription management server **300** performs verification of the network node **100** before providing the indication in step **S306** to the network node **100**.

(74) In some aspects, the verification of the network node **100** might be performed before the subscription management server **300** obtains the trigger in step **S302** from the network node **100**. Whether the verification of the network node **100** in step **S304** is performed before or after step **S302** might also depend on the type of verification that is made; verification relating to authentication might be performed before step **S304** whereas verification to policy check might be performed after step **S304**.

(75) As disclosed above, in some aspects, the subscription management server **300** performs

authentication of the subscriber entity **200** on behalf of the network node **100**. That is, in some embodiments the trigger is a request for the subscription management server **300** to perform EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity **200** as part of network registration of the subscriber entity **200** to the SNPN **30**.

(76) As disclosed above, in some aspects, the network node **100** explicitly queries the subscription management server **300** if there is any download subscription profile download event for the subscriber entity **200**. That is, in some embodiments, the trigger is a query from the network node **100** if there is a pending subscription profile download event for the subscriber entity **200** at the subscription management server **300**. The indication in step **S306** might then be a response message to the query.

(77) As disclosed above, in some aspects, the indication is indirect in the form of an EAP SUCCESS message provided from the subscription management server **300** to the subscriber entity **200**. That is, in some embodiments, the indication is an EAP SUCCESS message addressed to the subscriber entity **200**.

(78) As disclosed above, in some aspects, the indication in step **S306** is accompanied by subscription profile download event information of the pending subscription profile.

(79) A first particular embodiment for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity **200** based on at least some of the above disclosed embodiments will now be disclosed in detail with reference to the signalling diagram of FIG. 5.

(80) **S401**: The PLMN **20** (R) AN advertises the NID of the SNPN **30**.

(81) **S402**: If the subscriber entity **200** has not already done it, it generates its identity, SUCI, e.g. as “@SNPN **30**_NID”, i.e. the username part is empty and the realm is the SNPN **30** NID advertised by the PLMN **20** (R) AN, which is also pre-configured into the subscriber entity **200**. Furthermore, the subscriber entity **200** starts the 5G registration process.

(82) **S403**: The subscriber entity **200** provides the SUCI generated in step **S402** to the PLMN **20** (R) AN. The PLMN **20** (R) AN routes the message to the SNPN **30** based on the realm part of the SUCI.

(83) **S404**: The subscriber entity **200** and the SNPN **30** continue to run 5G registration, performing the authentication using (e.g.) EAP-TLS based authentication on the subscriber entity ID and associated certificate. The subscriber entity **200** verifies that the SNPN **30** has a CI issued certificate, i.e. is a trusted SNPN **30**.

(84) **S405**: The SNPN **30** receives and verifies the subscriber entity **200** certificate, e.g. subscriber entity ID (EID), and extracts the subscriber entity **200** certificate for use.

(85) **S406**: The SNPN **30**, using a secure channel, connects to the subscription management server **300** and provides the extracted subscriber entity ID in a request to the subscription management server **300** for information about associated subscription profile download events.

(86) **S407**: The subscription management server **300** verifies that the request is received from an entity authorized to use this interface (i.e. is allowed to request info about subscription profile download events of other subscriber entity IDs). This verification can be performed based on the CI issued certificate (or metadata in it) used by the SNPN **30** towards the subscription management server **300**, or based on pre-configured list of trusted SNNPs **30**.

(87) **S408**: If the SNPN **30** is authorized, the subscription management server **300** responds with information about subscription profile download events for the provided subscriber entity ID.

(88) **S409**: Assuming there is at least one subscription profile download event for the subscriber entity **200**, and the EAP-TLS authentication otherwise has been successful (i.e. the subscriber entity **200** uses a valid CI issued certificate), the SNPN **30** accepts the subscriber entity **200** as a valid subscriber.

(89) **S410**: The SNPN **30** responds with an EAP SUCCESS message, thereby completing a successful EAP-TLS authentication.

(90) **S411**: The subscriber entity **200** and SNPN **30** complete the 5G registration after which the

subscriber entity **200** has network connectivity through the SNPN **30**.

(91) **S412**: The subscriber entity **200** connects to the subscription management server **300** via the SNPN **30** to fetch subscription profile download events.

(92) If the SNPN **30** implements a whitelist for limiting entities to which subscriber entities **200** are allowed to connect, and if the subscription management server **300** the subscriber entity **200** connects to is not on the whitelist, the SNPN **30** could first verify that the subscription management server **300** has a valid CI issued certificate, after which the subscription management server **300** can be added to the whitelist.

(93) **S413**: The subscription management server **300** provides the subscription profile download event(s) to the subscriber entity **200** via the SNPN **30**.

(94) **S414**: Based on the received subscription profile download event information, the subscriber entity **200** connects to the subscription provisioning server **60** (as indicated by the subscription profile download event) via the SNPN **30** to download a subscription profile.

(95) If the subscription provisioning server **60** is not on the whitelist of the SNPN **30**, the SNPN **30** could verify that the contacted subscription provisioning server **60** has a valid CI issued certificate and after that add it to its whitelist (assuming the SNPN **30** uses a whitelist for limiting where subscriber entities **200** are allowed to connect).

(96) **S415**: The subscriber entity **200** obtains the subscription profile from the subscription provisioning server **60** via the SNPN **30** and can now disconnect from the SNPN **30** and start using its downloaded subscription profile.

(97) A second particular embodiment for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity **200** based on at least some of the above disclosed embodiments will now be disclosed in detail with reference to the signalling diagram of FIG. **6**. The embodiment of FIG. **6** is based on that the authentication part of the registration to an SNPN **30** might be handled by an external AAA server. In some aspects of the herein disclosed embodiments, this external AAA server is the subscription management server **300**. It might therefore be assumed that the subscription management server **300** supports EAP based authentication as that is what is to be used. The SNPN **30** AMF interacts with the SNPN **30** AUSF, which in turn interacts with the subscription management server **300** acting as external AAA server. Thus, here the AUSF takes the role as an EAP authenticator instead of EAP server. Once the authentication has been completed the AMF receives a key generated during registration and authentication, which can be used for generating the security context between the SNPN **30** and the subscriber entity **200**. In this embodiment steps A and B of FIG. **1** are thus merged. One benefit with this embodiment is that separate registration to the SNPN **30** followed by authentication to subscription management server **300** is not required.

(98) **S501**: The PLMN **20** (R) AN advertises the NID of the SNPN **30**.

(99) **S502**: If the subscriber entity **200** has not already done it, it generates its identity, SUCI, e.g. as “@SNPN **30**_NID”, i.e. the username part is empty and the realm is the SNPN **30** NID advertised by the PLMN **20** (R) AN, which is also pre-configured into the subscriber entity **200**. Furthermore, the subscriber entity **200** starts the 5G registration process.

(100) **S503**: The subscriber entity **200** provides the SUCI generated in step **S502** to the PLMN **20** (R) AN. The PLMN **20** (R) AN routes the message to the SNPN **30** based on the realm part of the SUCI.

(101) **S504**: As the (e.g.) EAP-TLS based authentication is to be run between the subscriber entity **200** and the external AAA, as represented by the subscription management server **300**, the SNPN **30** forwards the subscriber entity ID (i.e., the SUCI) to the subscription management server **300**.

(102) **S505**: The EAP-TLS is run between subscriber entity **200** and subscription management server **300** (subscription management server **300** must implement EAP). The subscriber entity **200** and the subscription management server **300** continue to run 5G registration, performing the authentication using (e.g.) EAP-TLS based authentication on the subscriber entity ID and associated certificate. The subscriber entity **200** verifies that the subscription management server

300 has a CI issued certificate, i.e. is a trusted subscription management server **300**.

(103) **S506**: The subscription management server **300** only accepts the authentication as successful if in addition to successfully running the authentication protocol, there is a subscription profile download event for the subscriber entity ID.

(104) **S507a**, **S507b**: An EAP SUCCESS message is sent from the subscription management server **300** via the SNPN **30** to the subscriber entity **200**. The SNPN **30** from the EAP SUCCESS message retrieves relevant keying material, and the keying material is not forwarded from the SNPN **30** to the subscriber entity **200**.

(105) **S508**: The subscriber entity **200** and SNPN **30** complete the 5G registration after which the subscriber entity **200** has network connectivity through the SNPN **30**.

(106) **S509**: The subscriber entity **200** connects to the subscription management server **300** via the SNPN **30** to fetch subscription profile download events.

(107) If the SNPN **30** implements a whitelist for limiting entities to which subscriber entities **200** are allowed to connect, and if the subscription management server **300** the subscriber entity **200** connects to is not on the whitelist, the SNPN **30** could first verify that the subscription management server **300** has a valid CI issued certificate, after which the subscription management server **300** can be added to the whitelist.

(108) **S510**: The subscription management server **300** provides the subscription profile download event to the subscriber entity **200** via the SNPN **30**.

(109) **S511**: Based on the received subscription profile download event information, the subscriber entity **200** connects to the subscription provisioning server **60** (as indicated by the subscription profile download event) via the SNPN **30** to download a subscription profile.

(110) If the subscription provisioning server **60** is not on the whitelist of the SNPN **30**, the SNPN **30** could verify that the contacted subscription provisioning server **60** has a valid CI issued certificate and after that add it to its whitelist (assuming the SNPN **30** uses a whitelist for limiting where subscriber entities **200** are allowed to connect).

(111) **S512**: The subscriber entity **200** obtains the subscription profile from the subscription provisioning server **60** via the SNPN **30** and can now disconnect from the SNPN **30** and start using its downloaded subscription profile.

(112) A third particular embodiment for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity **200** based on at least some of the above disclosed embodiments will now be disclosed in detail with reference to the signalling diagram of FIG. 6. The embodiment of FIG. 6 is based on removing the explicit step C of FIG. 1; the subscription profile download event information could be pushed to the subscriber entity **200** as part of the network registration if the subscription management server **300** provides the relevant information to the SNPN **30** (either visible to the SNPN **30** or as an encrypted blob that only the subscriber entity **200** can decrypt). The subscription management server **300** could in the EAP SUCCESS message to the SNPN **30** send the relevant parameters of the subscription profile download event, e.g. Activation Code (at least subscription provisioning server **60** address and activation code token or the full AC). In this way the subscriber entity **200** does not need to separately contact the subscription management server **300** for obtaining the subscription profile download event information. Rather, after successful registration, the subscriber entity **200** would have the AC and could based on the AC connect to the subscription provisioning server **60** via the SNPN **30** and download the subscription profile.

(113) **S601**: The PLMN **20** (R) AN advertises the NID of the SNPN **30**.

(114) **S602**: If the subscriber entity **200** has not already done it, it generates its identity, SUCI, e.g. as “@SNPN 30_NID”, i.e. the username part is empty and the realm is the SNPN **30** NID advertised by the PLMN **20** (R) AN, which is also pre-configured into the subscriber entity **200**. Furthermore, the subscriber entity **200** starts the 5G registration process.

(115) **S603**: The subscriber entity **200** provides the SUCI generated in step **S602** to the PLMN **20** (R) AN. The PLMN **20** (R) AN routes the message to the SNPN **30** based on the realm part of the

SUCI.

(116) **S604**: As the (e.g.) EAP-TLS based authentication is to be run between the subscriber entity **200** and the external AAA, as represented by the subscription management server **300**, the SNPN **30** forwards the subscriber entity ID (i.e., the SUCI) to the subscription management server **300**.

(117) **S605**: The EAP-TLS is run between subscriber entity **200** and subscription management server **300** (subscription management server **300** must implement EAP). The subscriber entity **200** and the subscription management server **300** continue to run 5G registration, performing the authentication using (e.g.) EAP-TLS based authentication on the subscriber entity ID and associated certificate. The subscriber entity **200** verifies that the subscription management server **300** has a CI issued certificate, i.e. is a trusted subscription management server **300**.

(118) **S606**: The subscription management server **300** only accepts the authentication as successful if in addition to successfully running the authentication protocol, there is a subscription profile download event for the subscriber entity ID.

(119) **S607a, S607b**: An EAP SUCCESS message is sent from the subscription management server **300** via the SNPN **30** to the subscriber entity **200**. The EAP SUCCESS message (or a separate message sent from the subscription management server **300** via the SNPN **30** to the subscriber entity **200**) comprises subscription profile download event information.

(120) The subscription profile download event information can be provided as plaintext since the communication channel between SNPN **30** and subscription management server **300** is secure or be encrypted by a key generated during the authentication exchange (or by a new key generated from keying material generated during the authentication exchange) so that the SNPN **30** does not learn the content of the subscription profile download event. The SNPN **30** could, alternatively and optionally, if it can read the content of the subscription profile download event, whitelist the subscription provisioning server **60** indicated in the subscription profile download event so that the subscriber entity **200** is allowed to access it for subscription profile download, i.e. the subscription provisioning server **60** is configured in the UPF as an accepted destination for outgoing traffic.

(121) The SNPN **30** from the EAP SUCCESS message retrieves relevant keying material, and the keying material is not forwarded from the SNPN **30** to the subscriber entity **200**.

(122) **S608**: The SNPN **30** communicates the subscription profile download event information to the subscriber entity **200**, either as additional data in the EAP SUCCESS message sent from the SNPN **30** to subscriber entity **200**, or in another message, such as in a short message service (SMS) text message or using a UE parameter update (UPE) message.

(123) **S609**: The subscriber entity **200** obtains the subscription profile from the subscription provisioning server **60** via the SNPN **30** and can now disconnect from the SNPN **30** and start using its downloaded subscription profile.

(124) Since the subscriber entity **200** from step **S608** already has relevant information of the subscription profile download event the subscriber entity **200** does not need to fetch any download subscription profile download event from the subscription management server **300** and instead proceeds to download the subscriber entity **200** subscription profile from subscription provisioning server **60** in step **S609** as soon as the subscriber entity **200** has completed network registration with the SNPN **30**.

(125) FIG. **8** schematically illustrates, in terms of a number of functional units, the components of a network node **100** according to an embodiment. Processing circuitry **110** is provided using any combination of one or more of a suitable central processing unit (CPU), multiprocessor, microcontroller, digital signal processor (DSP), etc., capable of executing software instructions stored in a computer program product **1410a** (as in FIG. **14**), e.g. in the form of a storage medium **130**. The processing circuitry **110** may further be provided as at least one application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or field programmable gate array (FPGA).

(126) Particularly, the processing circuitry **110** is configured to cause the network node **100** to perform a set of operations, or steps, as disclosed above. For example, the storage medium **130**

may store the set of operations, and the processing circuitry **110** may be configured to retrieve the set of operations from the storage medium **130** to cause the network node **100** to perform the set of operations. The set of operations may be provided as a set of executable instructions. Thus the processing circuitry **110** is thereby arranged to execute methods as herein disclosed.

(127) The storage medium **130** may also comprise persistent storage, which, for example, can be any single one or combination of magnetic memory, optical memory, solid state memory or even remotely mounted memory.

(128) The network node **100** may further comprise a communications interface **120** for communications with other functions, nodes, entities, and devices of the communication network **10**. As such the communications interface **120** may comprise one or more transmitters and receivers, comprising analogue and digital components.

(129) The processing circuitry **110** controls the general operation of the network node **100** e.g. by sending data and control signals to the communications interface **120** and the storage medium **130**, by receiving data and reports from the communications interface **120**, and by retrieving data and instructions from the storage medium **130**. Other components, as well as the related functionality, of the network node **100** are omitted in order not to obscure the concepts presented herein.

(130) FIG. **9** schematically illustrates, in terms of a number of functional modules, the components of a network node **100** according to an embodiment. The network node **100** of FIG. **9** comprises a number of functional modules; a receive module **110a** configured to perform step **S102**, and a grant module **110e** configured to perform step **S110**. The network node **100** of FIG. **9** may further comprise a number of optional functional modules, such as any of an obtain module **110b** configured to perform step **S104**, a query module **110c** configured to perform step **S106**, an obtain module **110d** configured to perform step **S108**. In general terms, each functional module **110a-110d** may be implemented in hardware or in software. Preferably, one or more or all functional modules **110a-110d** may be implemented by the processing circuitry **110**, possibly in cooperation with the communications interface **120** and the storage medium **130**. The processing circuitry **110** may thus be arranged to from the storage medium **130** fetch instructions as provided by a functional module **110a-110d** and to execute these instructions, thereby performing any steps of the network node **100** as disclosed herein.

(131) FIG. **10** schematically illustrates, in terms of a number of functional units, the components of a subscriber entity **200** according to an embodiment. Processing circuitry **210** is provided using any combination of one or more of a suitable central processing unit (CPU), multiprocessor, microcontroller, digital signal processor (DSP), etc., capable of executing software instructions stored in a computer program product **1410b** (as in FIG. **14**), e.g. in the form of a storage medium **230**. The processing circuitry **210** may further be provided as at least one application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or field programmable gate array (FPGA).

(132) Particularly, the processing circuitry **210** is configured to cause the subscriber entity **200** to perform a set of operations, or steps, as disclosed above. For example, the storage medium **230** may store the set of operations, and the processing circuitry **210** may be configured to retrieve the set of operations from the storage medium **230** to cause the subscriber entity **200** to perform the set of operations. The set of operations may be provided as a set of executable instructions. Thus the processing circuitry **210** is thereby arranged to execute methods as herein disclosed.

(133) The storage medium **230** may also comprise persistent storage, which, for example, can be any single one or combination of magnetic memory, optical memory, solid state memory or even remotely mounted memory.

(134) The subscriber entity **200** may further comprise a communications interface **220** for communications with other functions, nodes, entities, and devices of the communication network **10**. As such the communications interface **220** may comprise one or more transmitters and receivers, comprising analogue and digital components.

(135) The processing circuitry **210** controls the general operation of the subscriber entity **200** e.g.

by sending data and control signals to the communications interface **220** and the storage medium **230**, by receiving data and reports from the communications interface **220**, and by retrieving data and instructions from the storage medium **230**. Other components, as well as the related functionality, of the subscriber entity **200** are omitted in order not to obscure the concepts presented herein.

(136) FIG. **11** schematically illustrates, in terms of a number of functional modules, the components of a subscriber entity **200** according to an embodiment. The subscriber entity **200** of FIG. **11** comprises a number of functional modules; a provide module **210b** configured to perform step **S204**, a communication module **210c** configured to perform step **S206**, an obtain module **210d** configured to perform step **S208**, and a download module **210e** configured to perform step **S210**. The subscriber entity **200** of FIG. **11** may further comprise a number of optional functional modules, such as a scan module **210a** configured to perform step **S202**. In general terms, each functional module **210a-210e** may be implemented in hardware or in software. Preferably, one or more or all functional modules **210a-210e** may be implemented by the processing circuitry **210**, possibly in cooperation with the communications interface **220** and the storage medium **230**. The processing circuitry **210** may thus be arranged to from the storage medium **230** fetch instructions as provided by a functional module **210a-210e** and to execute these instructions, thereby performing any steps of the subscriber entity **200** as disclosed herein.

(137) FIG. **12** schematically illustrates, in terms of a number of functional units, the components of a subscription management server **300** according to an embodiment. Processing circuitry **310** is provided using any combination of one or more of a suitable central processing unit (CPU), multiprocessor, microcontroller, digital signal processor (DSP), etc., capable of executing software instructions stored in a computer program product **1410c** (as in FIG. **14**), e.g. in the form of a storage medium **330**. The processing circuitry **310** may further be provided as at least one application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or field programmable gate array (FPGA).

(138) Particularly, the processing circuitry **310** is configured to cause the subscription management server **300** to perform a set of operations, or steps, as disclosed above. For example, the storage medium **330** may store the set of operations, and the processing circuitry **310** may be configured to retrieve the set of operations from the storage medium **330** to cause the subscription management server **300** to perform the set of operations. The set of operations may be provided as a set of executable instructions. Thus the processing circuitry **310** is thereby arranged to execute methods as herein disclosed.

(139) The storage medium **330** may also comprise persistent storage, which, for example, can be any single one or combination of magnetic memory, optical memory, solid state memory or even remotely mounted memory.

(140) The subscription management server **300** may further comprise a communications interface **320** for communications with other functions, nodes, entities, and devices of the communication network **10**. As such the communications interface **320** may comprise one or more transmitters and receivers, comprising analogue and digital components.

(141) The processing circuitry **310** controls the general operation of the subscription management server **300** e.g. by sending data and control signals to the communications interface **320** and the storage medium **330**, by receiving data and reports from the communications interface **320**, and by retrieving data and instructions from the storage medium **330**. Other components, as well as the related functionality, of the subscription management server **300** are omitted in order not to obscure the concepts presented herein.

(142) FIG. **13** schematically illustrates, in terms of a number of functional modules, the components of a subscription management server **300** according to an embodiment. The subscription management server **300** of FIG. **13** comprises a number of functional modules; an obtain module **310a** configured to perform step **S302**, and a provide module **310c** configured to perform step **S306**. The subscription management server **300** of FIG. **13** may further comprise a

number of optional functional modules, such as a verify module **310b** configured to perform step **S304**. In general terms, each functional module **310a-310c** may be implemented in hardware or in software. Preferably, one or more or all functional modules **310a-310c** may be implemented by the processing circuitry **310**, possibly in cooperation with the communications interface **320** and the storage medium **330**. The processing circuitry **310** may thus be arranged to from the storage medium **330** fetch instructions as provided by a functional module **310a-310c** and to execute these instructions, thereby performing any steps of the subscription management server **300** as disclosed herein.

(143) FIG. **14** shows one example of a computer program product **1410a, 1410b, 1410c** comprising computer readable means **1430**. On this computer readable means **1430**, a computer program **1420a** can be stored, which computer program **1420a** can cause the processing circuitry **110** and thereto operatively coupled entities and devices, such as the communications interface **120** and the storage medium **130**, to execute methods according to embodiments described herein. The computer program **1420a** and/or computer program product **1410a** may thus provide means for performing any steps of the network node **100** as herein disclosed. On this computer readable means **1430**, a computer program **1420b** can be stored, which computer program **1420b** can cause the processing circuitry **210** and thereto operatively coupled entities and devices, such as the communications interface **220** and the storage medium **230**, to execute methods according to embodiments described herein. The computer program **1420b** and/or computer program product **1410b** may thus provide means for performing any steps of the subscriber entity **200** as herein disclosed. On this computer readable means **1430**, a computer program **1420c** can be stored, which computer program **1420c** can cause the processing circuitry **310** and thereto operatively coupled entities and devices, such as the communications interface **320** and the storage medium **330**, to execute methods according to embodiments described herein. The computer program **1420c** and/or computer program product **1410c** may thus provide means for performing any steps of the subscription management server **300** as herein disclosed.

(144) In the example of FIG. **14**, the computer program product **1410a, 1410b, 1410c** is illustrated as an optical disc, such as a CD (compact disc) or a DVD (digital versatile disc) or a Blu-Ray disc. The computer program product **1410a, 1410b, 1410c** could also be embodied as a memory, such as a random access memory (RAM), a read-only memory (ROM), an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM), or an electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM) and more particularly as a non-volatile storage medium of a device in an external memory such as a USB (Universal Serial Bus) memory or a Flash memory, such as a compact Flash memory. Thus, while the computer program **1420a, 1420b, 1420c** is here schematically shown as a track on the depicted optical disk, the computer program **1420a, 1420b, 1420c** can be stored in any way which is suitable for the computer program product **1410a, 1410b, 1410c**.

(145) The inventive concept has mainly been described above with reference to a few embodiments. However, as is readily appreciated by a person skilled in the art, other embodiments than the ones disclosed above are equally possible within the scope of the inventive concept, as defined by the appended patent claims.

Claims

1. A method for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity, the method being performed by a network node of an SNPN, the method comprising: receiving a request from the subscriber entity for network registration with EAP based authentication to the SNPN; and granting network connectivity for the subscriber entity to the SNPN by completing the network registration upon successful EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity, the network connectivity enabling subscription profile download to the subscriber entity.

2. The method according to claim 1, wherein the EAP based authentication is based on EAP-TLS authentication of the subscriber entity.
3. The method according to claim 1, wherein the EAP based authentication comprises verifying a CI issued certificate of the subscriber entity or an identifier of the subscriber entity.
4. The method according to claim 1, wherein the EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity is performed by the network node.
5. The method according to claim 1, further comprising: obtaining an indication from a subscription management server of successful EAP based authentication, as performed by the subscription management server, of the subscriber entity.
6. The method according to claim 5, wherein the indication is an EAP SUCCESS message obtained from the subscription management server and addressed to the subscriber entity.
7. The method according to claim 1, wherein the verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity is obtained as an indication from a subscription management server.
8. The method according to claim 7, wherein the indication is an EAP SUCCESS message obtained from the subscription management server and addressed to the subscriber entity.
9. The method according to claim 7, wherein the indication is obtained from the subscription management server in a response message to a querying.
10. The method according to claim 9, further comprising: querying the subscription management server for existence of the pending profile download event for the subscriber entity at the subscription management server.
11. The method according to claim 1, further comprising: obtaining event information of the pending subscription profile from a subscription management server.
12. The method according to claim 11, wherein, as part of completing the network registration, the network node provides, to the subscriber entity, the event information of the pending subscription profile.
13. A method for subscription profile download, the method being performed by a subscriber entity, the method comprising: a request for network registration with EAP based authentication to an SNPN; gaining network connectivity to the SNPN upon successful EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity; obtaining event information of the subscription profile; and downloading the subscription profile to the subscriber entity whilst utilizing the network connectivity to the SNPN.
14. The method according to claim 13, wherein the subscriber entity is configured with broadcast information of the SNPN to use for initial network connectivity, the method further comprising: scanning received wireless signals for the broadcast information before providing the request for EAP based network registration to the SNPN.
15. The method according to claim 14, wherein the broadcast information is a NID of the SNPN.
16. The method according to claim 13, wherein, as part of the network registration, the subscriber entity performs EAP based authentication with a subscription management server.
17. The method according to claim 13, wherein the event information of the pending subscription profile is obtained from the SNPN as part of completing the network registration.
18. A network node of an SNPN for enabling subscription profile download to a subscriber entity, the network node comprising processing circuitry, the processing circuitry being configured to cause the network node to: receive a request from the subscriber entity for network registration with EAP based authentication to the SNPN; and grant network connectivity for the subscriber entity to the SNPN by completing the network registration upon successful EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity, the network connectivity enabling subscription profile download to the subscriber entity.

19. A subscriber entity for subscription profile download, the subscriber entity comprising processing circuitry, the processing circuitry being configured to cause the subscriber entity to: provide a request for network registration with EAP based authentication to an SNPN; gain network connectivity to the SNPN upon successful EAP based authentication of the subscriber entity and upon verification that there is a pending subscription profile available for download to the subscriber entity; obtain event information of the subscription profile; and download the subscription profile to the subscriber entity whilst utilizing the network connectivity to the SNPN.
